

ORBI · DESIGN PROPOSAL

Visual reform

A palette, a motion system and a sound palette for the bubble universe — plus the order they get built in.

THE PROBLEM

Purple is a seventh colour competing with six that carry meaning. It paints the mic, the tab bar and every primary button, so the cluster colours have to shout over it on a near-black ground.

THE DIRECTION

Chrome becomes paper and ink. Colour is reserved for the thing colour is already doing a job for — the clusters. Light becomes the default and night stays, lifted off black.

WHAT IS INSIDE

The system, three screens redrawn in day and night, eight named animations with their durations, seven sounds with their rules, and a six-phase build plan with estimates.

The motion and sound pages are interactive on the canvas — the tiles play, and the sounds really sound. On paper they are shown at rest.

ORBI · VISUAL DIRECTION

The clusters are the brand

One accent colour cannot compete with six that carry meaning. Purple lost that fight — it painted the chrome, the mic and the tab bar, so the six cluster colours read as noise on top of it. Chrome becomes paper and ink. Colour is reserved for the thing colour is already doing a job for.

GROUND

Paper · #FBF9F6

Card · #FFFFFF

Night · #121620

Card · #1A1F2B

Today the app is night-only at #07080F — near-black, and cold. Light becomes the default; night stays, lifted off black so it reads as evening rather than a void.

CLUSTERS retuned for paper — each differs in lightness, not hue alone



Work
#2B6CB0



Health
#15803D



Finance
#A16207



Personal
#7C3AED



Home
#C2410C



Learning
#0E7490



Adrift
#6B7280



Overdue
#BE123C

INK — EVERY PRIMARY ACTION

Add to universe

Cancel

No brand hue on buttons. Ink is unmistakably the action, ages well, and leaves the six colours their meaning.

THE MIC BORROWS





Its aura takes the colour of the cluster you are inside. The universe tints the tool, not the reverse.

TYPE & FORM

€311.21

Fraunces — numbers and headlines only

Pick up the brushes

Plus Jakarta Sans — everything else

A serif for the few big numbers is where the personality goes. The interface itself stays quiet.



8 · chips



12 · buttons, inputs



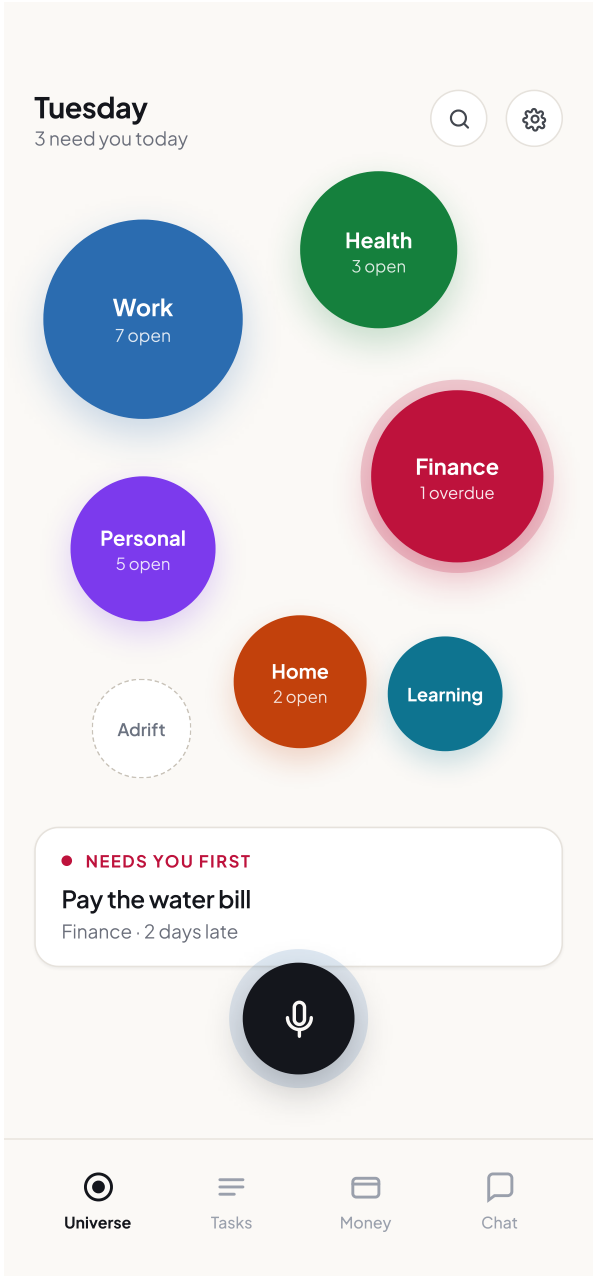
16 · cards



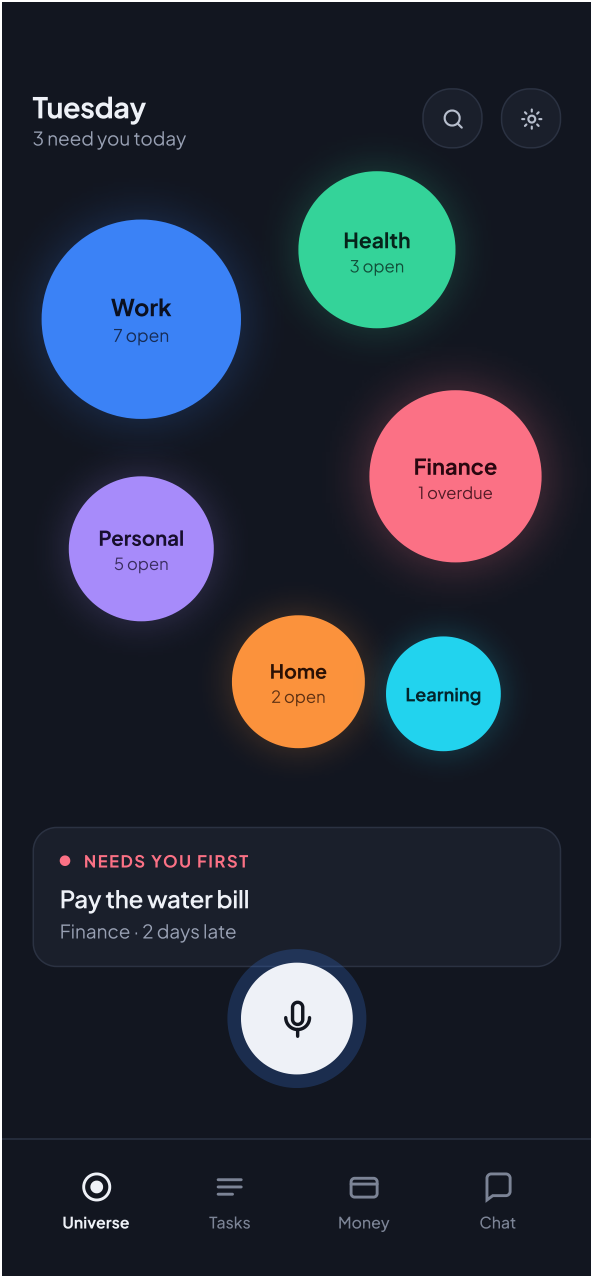
22 · sheets

Shadows stay almost invisible: 0 1px 2px at 6%, 0 8px 24px at 8% for sheets. Depth from spacing, not haze.

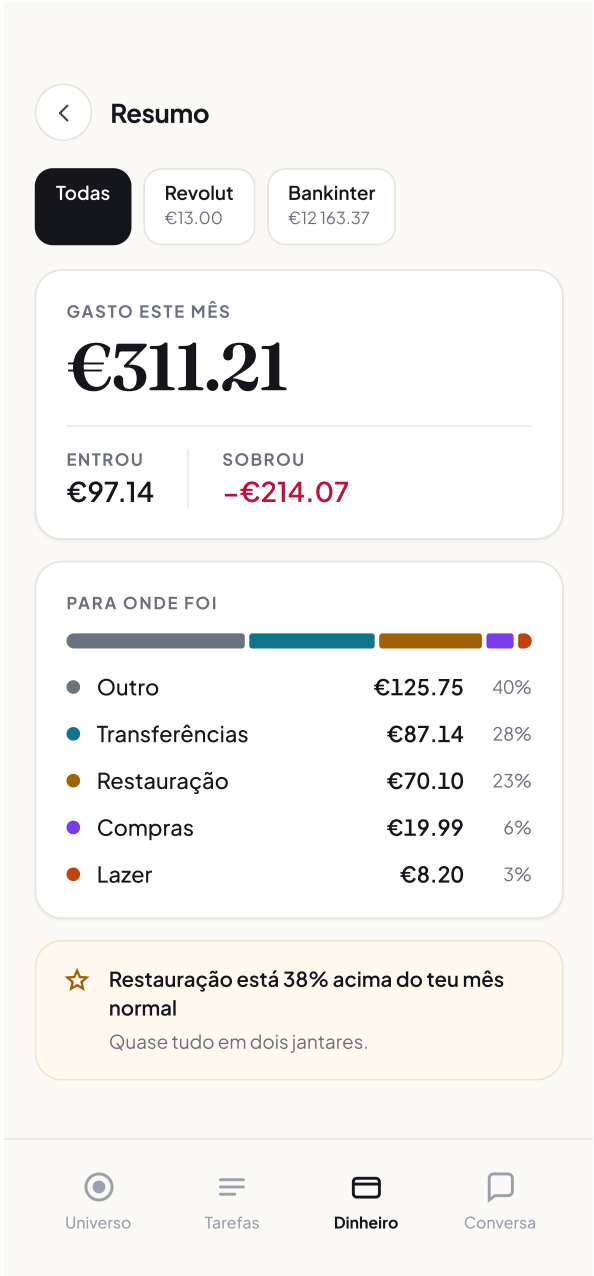
The same three screens, redrawn 390 × 844



Universe — day



Universe — night, lifted off black



Money — Resumo, with the account pills fixed

MOTION — CLICK ANY TILE

Fast enough to feel free, slow enough to read

Three speeds only. Anything longer than 400ms is something you wait for, and a to-do app that makes you wait for its own confidence trick gets deleted.

120ms · micro — press, toggle, ripple

220ms · standard — sheets, tabs, navigation

380ms · expressive — completion, cluster zoom

Easing **cubic-bezier(.2, 0, 0, 1)**

Bubbles **spring · damping 15, stiffness 180**

Add to universe

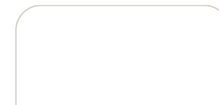
Press

scale .94 · 120ms · light haptic



Completed

ring out, bubble sinks · 380ms



Sheet

rise 46px · 220ms



Tab switch

icon pop 1.22 · 180ms



Enter a cluster

the bubble becomes the screen · 320ms

Limit reached

Refused

shake 5px · 240ms · warning haptic



Breathing (always)

±2% over 7s, phase-offset per bubble



Overdue (always)

halo pulse 2.4s — the only looping alarm

Reduce Motion is not a downgrade path. When the system flag is on, every looping animation stops outright — breathing, the overdue halo, the mic aura — and transitions collapse to an 80ms opacity fade. Overdue then reads through colour and the red dot alone, which it must anyway for anyone who cannot see the pulse. Nothing may be communicated by movement only.

Sound

shown at rest — these play on the canvas

SOUND — TURN YOUR VOLUME DOWN, THEN CLICK

Soft, tuned, and easy to never hear

Every sound is one soft sine in the same key (A minor), under 400ms, peaking around -24 dBFS. They are generated here so you can hear the real thing rather than read an adjective.



Tap a bubble

A5 sine, 70ms, instant decay. Pitch rises slightly with the bubble's pressure.



Completed

A → E, 260ms. The only sound allowed to feel like a reward.



Mic opens

A soft swell up, 180ms. Its job is to tell you recording started without a word.



Mic closes

The same swell downward, 150ms. A pair, so the two are obviously one gesture.



Task captured

Two quick notes, 140ms. Lighter than completion — arriving is not finishing.



Refused

A muted low thud, 160ms. Deliberately dull, never a buzzer — being at a limit is not a crime.



Universe hum

Three detuned voices, 2.5s here. **Off by default** — ambience is a preference, never a default.

Haptics carry it alone

Every sound has a haptic twin, and the haptic fires whether or not sound is on. Most people run a phone silent; the app has to feel complete that way.

THE RULES THAT KEEP IT FROM BECOMING ANNOYING

Silent switch wins. Sounds route through the ambient category, so a silenced phone stays silent. No exceptions, not even for alarms.

Never during quiet hours. The same window that governs reminders governs sound, so the app is consistent about when it is allowed to speak.

One per 120ms. Completing six tasks quickly plays one sound, not six. A queue of chimes is what makes people mute an app forever.

Never over your audio. Detect other playback and drop to haptics only, rather than ducking someone's podcast for a tick.

SHIPPING THEM

These are synthesised in the browser to demo. On the phone they ship as seven small AAC files played through expo-audio, which is already a dependency. Total weight under 40 KB.

Synthesising on device would cost a second audio graph for no gain — these never change at runtime.

How it gets built

six phases, roughly a week

THE ORDER IT GETS BUILT IN

Tokens first, or every screen gets edited twice

Today `theme/colors.ts` exports raw hexes that 40 screens import by name — `colors.panel`, `colors.accent`. That single file is why this is a week of work and not a month, and why phase A must come first.

A Tokens

~1 day

Turn the palette into semantic names with a light and a night value each — `surface`, `ink`, `line`, `action` — behind a `useTheme()` hook, with the old keys kept as aliases.

Ships nothing visible. That is the point: the app looks identical and every later phase becomes a small diff.

B Daylight

~2 days

Light becomes the default and a Settings toggle offers Light / Night / System. Chrome goes paper-and-ink: headers, cards, tab bar, sheets, the shared `ActionBar` and `ScreenHeader`.

The one that fixes “depressing.” Everything after this is refinement.

C The universe

~2 days

Repaint the Skia canvas: retuned cluster colours, soft shadow instead of flat fill, breathing at $\pm 2\%$, the overdue halo, and the mic aura that borrows the current cluster’s colour.

Watch the frame rate. Shadows on 50 Skia circles are the one thing here that can cost real performance; measure before keeping them.

D Motion

~1.5 days

One `motion.ts` holding the three durations, the easing and the spring, plus the eight named animations. Reanimated is already installed and the drag gesture already uses it.

Reduce Motion in the same commit, never as a follow-up nobody schedules.

E Sound

~1 day

Seven AAC files through `expo-audio`, a haptic twin for each, one `feedback.ts` that owns the throttle, the quiet-hours check and the silent-switch category.

Sound on, hum off. Both switchable in Settings, next to the existing toggles.

F What I would not do yet

Custom illustration, an animated onboarding, a mascot, or a bespoke icon set. Each is weeks, each dates fast, and none of them is why the app currently feels heavy.

A tuned palette, air, and eight animations get you most of the way. Decide on the rest once real people have used it.

⚠ One honest caveat about sequencing. This is roughly a week of work that ships no new capability, while payments, the domain, Enable Banking and an EAS build are all still open — and a test release cannot happen without those. Phase A and B alone fix what you actually complained about and cost about three days; C to E are worth doing after there is something to install. Doing all six now is a defensible choice, just not a free one.